Writing Part 3

RULES 1–2

Rule 1

Subject–verb agreement

The subject and verb must agree in **number** (singular/plural) and **person**.

🔗 **1. Prepositional phrases do not affect the subject**

The noun after a preposition is not the subject.

✗ Students without SATUstoz is nothing!

✓ Students with SATUstoz are unstoppable!

👥 **2. Collective nouns = singular**

A group acting as one unit is singular.

✗ The team are playing badly.

😉 Did the team suddenly split into 11 independent rebels? NO!

✓ The team is playing badly.

🎯 **3. "Every" / "each" = singular**

✓ Each of the students is ready to leave the class now.

🏃 **4. Gerunds (-ing forms) = singular**

✓ Coming late is not cool.

✓ Losing track of time with administrators is easy.

⚖️ **5. Either…or / neither…nor / …or**

The verb agrees with the closest noun.

✓ Either the students or the teacher **IS** responsible for 1550.

✓ Either the teacher or the students **ARE** responsible for 1550.

Rule 2

Inverted syntax

Sometimes the normal word order is flipped so that **the verb comes before the subject**.

STANDARD (NORMAL ORDER)

The cat sat on the mat.

S → V → (rest)

INVERTED (VERB COMES FIRST)

On the mat sat the cat.

(rest) → V → S

BREAKDOWN

🐈 **The cat** — subject

✅ **Sat** — verb (or the test you're preparing for)

💡 **Quick tip:** When you see words like **here, there, on the mat, in the room, at the top of the page**, etc. at the beginning of a sentence, be ready for inverted syntax!

Master the rules. Own the test.

Writing Part 3

RULES 3–6

Rule 3 Parallelism

Verbs in a list, a pair, or a comparison must be **parallel in form**.

1. Pair
infinitive vs gerund

× He likes **to study** and **crying** during SAT practice.
✓ He likes **to study** and **to suffer** through SAT practice.

2. List
parallel structure

× She **studies** hard, **focused** on goals, and **will succeed**.
✓ She **studies** hard, **focuses** on goals, and **succeeds**.

3. Comparison
parallel structure

× The SAT is more stressful than **the most predictable**.
✓ The SAT is more stressful than **predictable**.

Comparison words: as well as, as … as, not only … but also, more than, less than, both … and

Rule 4 Participles parallelism

× 👩 Miss Ruma, tired of work and **created** this handout, is dangerous.

✓ 👩 Miss Ruma, tired of work and **creating** this handout, is dangerous.

💡 Look, we are describing Miss Ruma. Does it mean someone else created Miss Ruma and the handout at the same time? **NO!**

Rule 5 Compare the same type of thing

We must compare things that are grammatically and logically the same type.

× ⚖️ The behavior of dogs is more predictable than **cats**.

✓ ⚖️ The behavior of dogs is more predictable than **THAT OF** cats.

FORMULA

those → replaces a plural noun
that → replaces a singular noun

Rule 6 Modifier–subject agreement

× Exhausted from the hike, **the cookies** tasted delicious.
✓ Exhausted from the hike, **we ate cookies** that tasted delicious.

✏️ The part before the comma is a modifier. Ask yourself: **what can be exhausted from the hike?** Then choose the subject accordingly.

× Similar to those of Unlock, **Freshman Academy** has cool results.
✓ Similar to those of Unlock, **Freshman Academy's results** are cool.

✏️ We can't compare "those of" with "Freshman Academy" itself, so we must insert the subject **"results."**

Writing Part 3

RULES 7–10

Rule 7 Appositive (name case)

CASE 1: NAME › › › DESCRIPTION

- [The] Profession Name → normally no commas
- A/an + profession, Name → the profession is non-essential

Examples: ① A killer, Patrick is coming home. ② Patrick, a killer, is coming home. ③ Patrick, the killer, is coming home.

CASE 2: UNIQUE DESCRIPTION › › › NAME

- [The] Profession Name → normally no commas
- [The] UNIQUE Profession, Name, → the name becomes non-essential

Examples: ① The killer Patrick is coming home. ② The main villain of the "American Psycho" movie, Patrick Bateman, is now 51 years old. ③ Alexander the Great is coming home.

😈 **Thinking task:** Explain why sentence 3 in Case 1 and sentence 3 in Case 2 differ.

I am genius Tony.
× "genius" is not a title

I am Tony, a genius, billionaire, playboy, philanthropist.
✓ name first, description is extra

Rule 8 Pronoun–antecedent agreement

A pronoun and the word it replaces should agree in **number, person, and gender**.

× The soap in the bathroom was pink. Their / His smell resembled strawberry, too!

✓ The soap in the bathroom was pink. **Its** smell resembled strawberry, too!



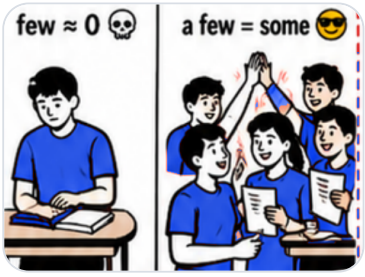
Rule 9 Few vs a few

few = almost none (bad)
a few = several (okay)

few ≈ 0
a few = some

⚠️ **Few** students at SATUstoz can squat 40 times in a minute. (almost nobody)

👍 **A few** of them can because they study in Ahror's group. (several of them)



Rule 10 Possessive 's / s'

- A NOUN must come after 's
- 's = noun
- s = adjective + noun
- You can't use "of" and 's in the same phrase

× The roof's of the house is broken.
✓ The house's roof is broken.
✓ The roof of the house is broken.

CONTRACTIONS

you're = you are / **your** = belonging to you
they're = they are / **their** = belonging to them / **there** = place
it's = it is / **its** = belonging to it / **its'** ×



★ **Good grammar = clear communication = strong impression** ★